

length and covered a mixture of projects, regions, counties, and states. They show that for every 10% increase in metropolitan lane miles, traffic increases 3% to 6% in the first few years and 6% to 10% in the following five to ten years. In other words, a road is likely to fill up long before it's due for reconstruction. Several more recent studies in the U.S. strengthen these claims and one in Hungary suggests that the phenomenon also works in reverse when road capacity is reduced. These findings seem to apply to